

Tournament update — July 9

7 teams left. France just beat Morocco 2-0.

Model's #1 pick

Morocco — OUT



FIFA WORLD CUP 2026™

1 TOURNAMENT UPDATE — JULY 9



FRANCE

#1

30.3%

CHAMPION PROBABILITY



QF RESULT:

FRANCE **2-0** MOROCCO

7 TEAMS STILL IN:



FRANCE



ARGENTINA



SPAIN



ENGLAND



BELGIUM



NORWAY



SWITZERLAND

2 RECENTLY ELIMINATED



BRAZIL

(lost to Norway in R16)



PORTUGAL

(lost to Spain in R16)



MOROCCO

(lost to France in QF)

How accurate so far?

The model picked the favorite in 20 of 25 knockout games.



KNOCKOUT TRACK RECORD

20 / 25

matches correct
(80%)

Round of 32 **13 / 16**

Round of 16 **6 / 8**

Quarter-finals **1 / 1**

TOP 5 CONTENDERS ALL STILL ALIVE

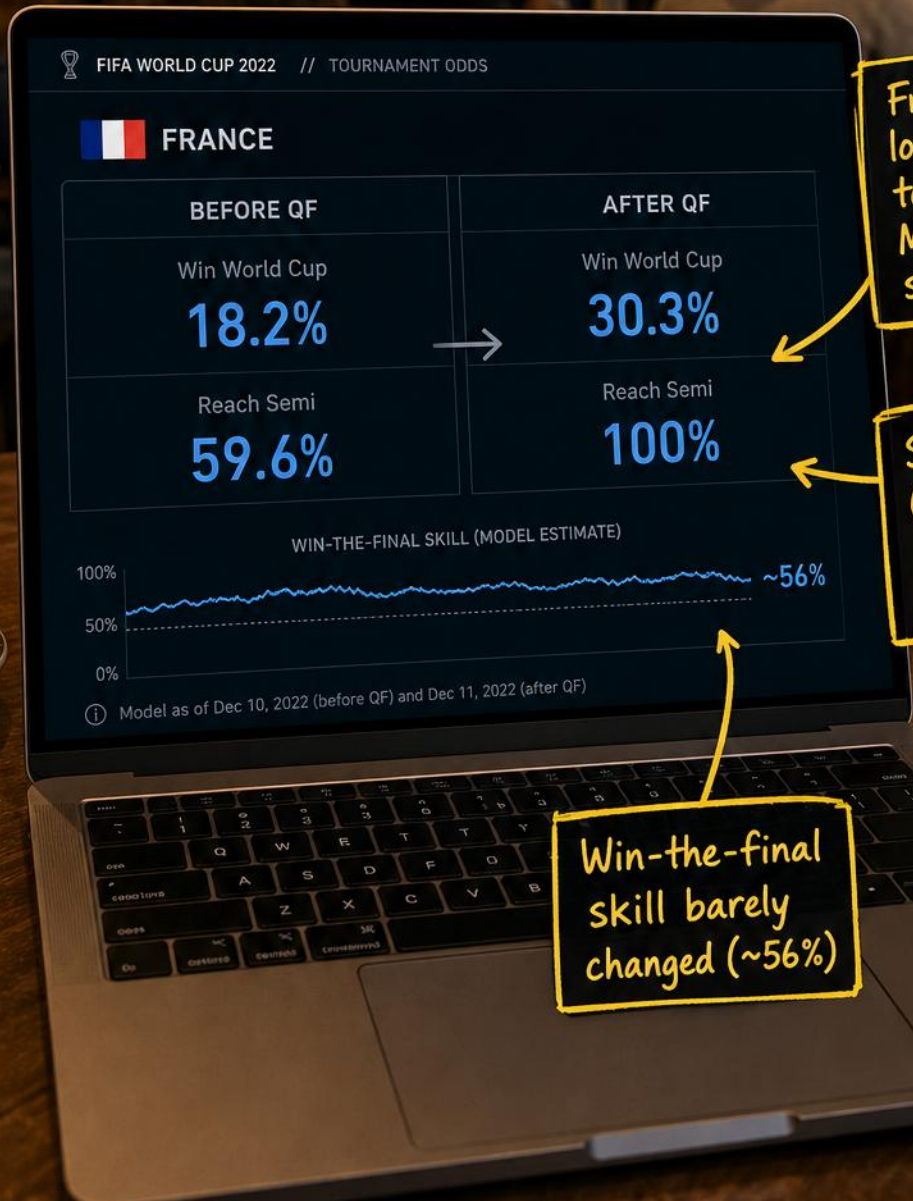
- | | | | |
|---|---|-----------|-------|
| 1 |  | France | 30.3% |
| 2 |  | Argentina | 18.9% |
| 3 |  | Spain | 15.4% |
| 4 |  | England | 15.1% |
| 5 |  | Belgium | 10.1% |

All top 5 favorites still in the tournament



Why did France jump so much?

Bracket math — not the model suddenly rating France higher.



France no longer has to beat Morocco in simulation

Same model. One real result locked in.

Win-the-final skill barely changed (~56%)



Model limitations (1/2)

4/6

Documented in the project –
not hidden.

KNOWN LIMITATIONS – DATA & FEATURES

- FIFA rankings use a 2026 snapshot for all historical training matches
- Top predictors are backward-looking: FIFA points, H2H, ranking diffs
- Rolling form features exist but carry less weight (~4% each)
- Elo ratings are a current snapshot – 36% null in training data

Model notes

- Data quality
- Features
- Validation



Model limitations (2/2)

What this model can and can't do.

KNOWN LIMITATIONS — SCOPE & ACCURACY



No player-level data — injuries, suspensions, squad depth not modeled



~62.1% match accuracy on competitive internationals (2018-2026)



Match model predicts pairwise outcomes; bracket tree enforced in simulation



Not a betting system — built as an ML learning project

Dropping FIFA rank alone barely changes performance — points_diff carries the signal

MODEL NOTE

- features
- training
- tuning
- validation



Predict → Simulate

DATA
>
OPINION

Try it yourself

Live dashboard + open-source code on GitHub



Live app — link in caption



GitHub repo — link in caption

Updates
daily during
the tournament



FIFA WORLD CUP 2026

CHAMPION ODDS

- | | |
|--------------|-------|
| 1. France | 30.3% |
| 2. Argentina | 18.9% |
| 3. Spain | 15.4% |
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BRACKET STATUS — JULY 9

✓ QF played: France 2-0 Morocco
(France through)

Still to play:

- Spain vs Belgium
- Norway vs England
- Argentina vs Switzerland

7 teams left: France, Argentina,
Spain, England, Belgium, Norway,
Switzerland